

```
def index(request):
    html = "Hello world, No page requested"
    if request.GET.has_key('page_no'):
        html = "Hello World, Page requested is no: %s" % request.GET['page_no']
    return HttpResponse(html)
```

Now the page responds according to the GET request variable, `page_no`. Try different URLs—for example, `http://127.0.0.1:8000/helloworld/?page_id=100` and `http://127.0.0.1:8000/helloworld/`

We will now look at how to handle `page/15/-` type URL mapping to views—for example, `http://127.0.0.1:8000/helloworld/page/44/`. Peeking inside the `urls.py` file, we have:

```
urlpatterns = patterns('',
    (r'^helloworld/page/(?P<page_id>\d+)/$', 'helloworld.views.page'),
)
```

The view function in `views.py`:

```
def page(request, page_id):
    return HttpResponse("This is Page: %s" % page_id)
```

Here, `(?P<page_id>\d+)` is the regular expression technique used: `\d+` defines the type of data, i.e., the digits; and `<page_id>` defines the name of the variable, so that we can use it as an argument for the view function `page`.

The view function can parse the page number from the URL and set `page_id=number`, so that we can manipulate the output `HttpResponse` according to that page number.

Here we have discussed a simple `HttpResponse`, which always returns HTML code given as an argument. Now we will look at how to deal with templates.

From now, we will place the HTML code as separate `.html` files, instead of inside the view function—and we call them as templates. Set the templates directory in `settings.py`:

```
TEMPLATE_DIRS = (
    "/home/slymox/APP/helloworld/html_templates"
)
```

Create an HTML file in the `html_templates/` directory called `template1.html`, with the following content:

```
<html>
<head><title> Django Hello Web project</title></head>
<body>
<p> This is a helloworld template</p>
<table>
<tr><td>Student</td><td>Roll No</td></tr>
<tr><td>S1</td><td>3</td></tr>
<tr><td>S2</td><td>2</td></tr>
<tr><td>S3</td><td>3</td></tr>
</table>
</body>
</html>
```

Now we can modify the view function to support the templates. The HTML interface code is taken through a `get_template` function. Here, `Context()` has a dictionary argument. It takes the variables and objects to be passed to the template to generate dynamic code. However, no objects are passed to the template—the template is just a static HTML page:

```
def index(request):
    from django.template.loader import get_template
    from django.template import Context
    site_template = get_template('template1.html')
    html = site_template.render(Context({}))
    return HttpResponse(html)
```

Or we can write the same template rendering in one line using the `render_to_response` shortcut as follows:

```
def index(request):
    from django.shortcuts import render_to_response
    return render_to_response('template1.html', {})
```

We will receive an output like what's shown below:

This is a helloworld template

Student	Roll No
S1	1
S2	2
S3	3

This is purely static. Now we will write a dynamic page utilising the facilities of the Django template system. Change the table section of `template1.html` to the following:

```
<table>
<tr><td>Student</td><td>Roll No</td></tr>
<% for name,rollno in student_list.items %>
<tr><td>{{name}}</td><td>{{rollno}}</td></tr>
<% endfor %>
</table>
also add the following code just above the <table>
<%( if flag %>
    Flag is on.
<% else %>
    Flag is off.
<% endif %>
</p>
```

...and the new view function to:

```
def index(request):
    from django.shortcuts import render_to_response
    flag=False
    if request.GET.has_key('flag'):
        flag=True
    student_list = {'S1':1, 'S2':2, 'S3':3, 'S4':4}
    return render_to_response('template1.html', {'student_list':student_list, 'flag':flag})
```